

Opener

WHAT KIND OF THING IS AI?

It's not magic.
Not a person.
Not a search engine.
Not normal software.
— *it's its own kind of thing.*

You've been using AI now, making real choices about apps, models, and prompts. This is where it stops being magic. Once you see how the machine actually works, the hype, the fear, the weird mistakes all start to make sense, and the judgment you've started building gets a lot harder to fool.

Think about driving a car. You can get good at it without ever opening the hood. But the driver who knows what the engine is doing reads trouble early, pushes the machine further, and never gets fooled by a strange noise. Knowing what's underneath is what turns a user into someone in control.

That's what this section is. It's the longest one in the course, and because AI works unlike anything you've used before, parts will feel complicated. That's normal. Take it a piece at a time. Each one builds on the last, and by the end, the machine won't feel like magic anymore.

IN THIS SECTION

How AI Really Works

IT ALL RUNS ON MATH

1

See the handful of math ideas underneath it, then watch your words get turned into numbers the machine can work with.

INSIDE THE BLACK BOX

2

AI gets called a "black box." You're about to open it and find real, understandable machinery inside, even if parts stay genuinely hard to explain.

WHERE IT ALL COMES TOGETHER

3

Every piece you've learned snaps into place here. Watch one answer get built from scratch, and you'll never look at a reply the same way again.